

Tuesday, 8 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Drizzle

20° 14°

BIRMINGHAM

Light rain

18° 13°

MANCHESTER

Heavy drizzle

16° 12°

GLASGOW

Rain

14° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **Jaguar Land Rover has announced it will cut 4,000 jobs over the next two years, in a significant blow to the UK manufacturing sector.**

The carmaker is facing tough competition in China, along with the impact of US tariffs and the huge costs of transitioning to electric vehicles. This move highlights the ongoing challenges for British industry.

BUSINESS · UK

- 2 **The Chancellor has urged for 'confidence about Britain' despite what he described as 'historic high' borrowing costs.**

John Healey's comments come ahead of his first Budget, where he's expected to outline plans to spread economic growth more widely across the UK. It's a crucial time for the nation's finances.

POLITICS · UK

- 3 **Buckingham Palace has made it clear that Prince Harry and Meghan, the Duchess of Sussex, remain non-working royals.**

Palace sources indicate a letter has been sent to Prince Harry's team, the government, military, and Lord Lieutenants, solidifying their official status. This reaffirms the structure of the Royal Family.

ROYALS · UK

- 4 **Police have made murder arrests after the tragic death of a baby girl whose body was found in woodland.**

Two men and two women have been arrested as part of the ongoing investigation. This is a deeply distressing case that has shocked communities.

CRIME · UK

- 5 **Dating app Grindr is set to pay £26 million to settle claims that it allegedly shared users' HIV status.**

The long-running legal claim accused Grindr of breaching UK privacy laws by sharing sensitive data with third parties. It raises serious questions about data protection for app users.

TECHNOLOGY · UK

What's coming up

1 Great news for fans of The Inbetweeners! Netflix has confirmed a new film is on the way, with the original cast set to return.

The beloved coming-of-age sitcom stars are reprising their roles for the new movie. Get ready for more awkward teenage antics and classic catchphrases.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Inbetweeners moment or line?

FILM · COMING SOON

2 Comedian Munya Chawawa is making a big leap from social media to Shakespeare, as he prepares for his stage acting debut.

Known for his hilarious online sketches and characters, Munya says he's keen to move away from social content. It'll be fascinating to see him tackle classical theatre.

ON AIR – Can you imagine Munya Chawawa in a Shakespeare play? Which role would suit him best?

THEATRE · COMING SOON

3 The rumour mill is in overdrive about the next James Bond, with speculation that an announcement could be just around the corner.

Fans are eagerly awaiting news on who will take over from Daniel Craig as 007. The casting of Bond is always one of the biggest talking points in cinema.

ON AIR – Who do you think should be the next James Bond? And what car should he drive?

FILM · COMING SOON

4 From boy band stage to racecourse! JJ Hamblett is swapping pop for ponies, as he takes part in a charity horse race this week.

The former Union J singer will be riding at Doncaster Racecourse on September 11th. It's quite a change of pace for the pop star!

ON AIR – If you could try any sport for charity, what would it be?

EVENT · THIS WEEK

5 The new presenters of The Grand Tour have spoken out, saying they 'hope we prove the critics wrong' as they take the wheel.

A new trio has taken over the motoring TV show from Jeremy Clarkson, Richard Hammond, and James May. They certainly have big shoes to fill!

ON AIR – Will you be tuning in to see the new Grand Tour presenters? Do you think they can live up to the original trio?

TV · COMING SOON

On the schedule

- 1 Can England captain Harry Kane buck history and win the prestigious Ballon d'Or award this year?**

Usually, the award goes to players who have recently lifted a major trophy. Despite his incredible goal-scoring form, Kane hasn't won a major honour recently, making his chances an interesting talking point.

ON AIR – Do you think Harry Kane deserves to win the Ballon d'Or, even without a major trophy?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Tyson Fury has thrown the highly anticipated all-British heavyweight fight with Anthony Joshua into doubt, by suggesting he needs a new opponent.**

Fury sparked more speculation that the November bout is on the verge of collapse. Boxing fans will be desperate for clarity on this huge fight.

ON AIR – Do you think the Tyson Fury vs Anthony Joshua fight will actually happen, or is Fury just playing games?

BOXING · UK
- 3 England have appointed former Ashes-winning batter Kevin Pietersen to their white-ball coaching team.**

Pietersen joins the setup in the build-up to the 2027 ICC Cricket World Cup. It's a big name addition that could bring a lot of experience to the squad.

ON AIR – What do you make of Kevin Pietersen joining England's coaching team? Good move or not?

CRICKET · UK
- 4 Real Madrid forward Kylian Mbappe believes this could be the year he finally wins the Ballon d'Or for the first time.**

Mbappe's comments come as he continues his incredible form for club and country. The race for football's top individual prize is always fiercely contested.

ON AIR – Mbappe thinks he could win the Ballon d'Or. Is he the best player in the world right now?

FOOTBALL · GLOBAL
- 5 Teenage darts sensation Luke Littler has continued his phenomenal year by winning the Czech Open.**

Littler overcame defending champion Luke Humphries in the final to claim another title on the European Tour. He just keeps on winning!

ON AIR – Luke Littler just keeps racking up the wins! Is he the most exciting talent in British sport right now?

DARTS · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The simple act of 'window-gazing' is being rediscovered as a mindful way to relax.**
Many are finding peace and inspiration simply by looking out their windows, watching the world go by. It's a lovely, free way to disconnect and unwind.
- 2 Home baking enthusiasts are turning to 'ancient grain' recipes for delicious new flavours.**
From spelt to einkorn, these heritage grains are offering bakers exciting textures and nutritional benefits, bringing a touch of history to modern kitchens.
- 3 A charming trend sees more people 'decorating their garden tools' with personalised designs.**
Gardeners are adding splashes of colour and character to their spades and trowels, making their outdoor work even more joyful and unique.
- 4 The humble 'doorstop' is undergoing a surprising design revolution.**
No longer just functional, doorstops are becoming stylish home accessories, crafted from unusual materials and in playful shapes to complement any decor.
- 5 More people are enjoying the soothing art of 'leaf pressing' to preserve autumn's beauty.**
Collecting and pressing colourful leaves is a wonderful way to connect with nature and create beautiful, lasting decorations for your home.
- 6 A new appreciation for 'community notice boards' is bringing local neighbourhoods closer.**
From lost cats to local events, these traditional boards are proving to be a valuable hub for sharing information and fostering a sense of community spirit.
- 7 The delightful hobby of 'collecting vintage postcards' is seeing a resurgence.**
People are enjoying the thrill of finding beautiful old cards, each with its own story, offering a fascinating glimpse into the past and different places.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of crisps will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: ...GIVING THE BAG A LITTLE SHAKE TO HEAR THE CRUNCH POTENTIAL!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot drink, especially if it's a new mug. What is it?

ANSWER: ...GIVING THE MUG A LITTLE TAP WITH YOUR SPOON TO CHECK ITS 'RING'!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'smell' can instantly transport you back to a specific childhood memory or a happy time?

What's that one scent that just instantly takes you on a trip down memory lane, and what memory does it bring back for you?

- We all have that 'one household item' that we've had for ages, which might not be fancy, but it just brings you joy or makes your daily routine a little bit easier, don't we?

What's that unassuming, perhaps even a bit old-fashioned, item in your home that you simply couldn't do without, and why is it so special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know, the 'puffin' can hold up to 10 fish in its beak at once, thanks to its special hinged jaw and spiny tongue?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The 'colour orange' was named after the fruit, but before that, the colour was simply referred to as 'yellow-red' in English.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.7 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.7 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A 'group of owls' is called a parliament.
- The 'kingfisher' is the only bird known to be able to hover backwards.
- The 'world's largest living organism' is a fungus called *Armillaria ostoyae*, found in Oregon, USA, covering over 2,200 acres.
- The 'Great Wall of China' is not visible from space with the naked eye, despite popular myth.
- The 'human body' contains enough iron to make a nail about three inches long.
- The 'longest place name' in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlllantysiliogogoch, a village in Wales.
- The 'surface area of a human lung' is roughly the size of a tennis court.
- The 'only letter' that does not appear in the periodic table is J.

On this day

Day 251 of the year, 114 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Adrian and Natalia of Nicomedia (Roman Catholic Church); Christian Feast Day: Corbinian; Christian Feast Day: Disibod; Christian Feast Day: Blessed Frédéric Ozanam. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1990 — Jos Buttler, English cricketer
- 1934 — Bernard Donoughue, Baron Donoughue, English academic and politician
- 1971 — Dustin O'Halloran, American pianist and composer
- 1973 — Gabriel McNair, American saxophonist, keyboard player, and composer
- 1994 — Shane Griffin, Norwegian professional footballer
- 1944 — Peter Bellamy, English singer-songwriter (died 1991)
- 1945 — Ron "Pigpen" McKernan, American singer-songwriter and keyboard player (died 1973)
- 1975 — Larenz Tate, American actor, director, and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2023 — A magnitude 6.9 earthquake strikes Morocco, killing nearly 3,000 people and damaging historic sites in Marrakesh.
- 2017 — Syrian civil war: The Syrian Democratic Forces (SDF) announce the beginning of the Deir ez-Zor campaign, with the stated aim of eliminating the Islamic State (IS) from all areas north and east of the Euphrates.
- 1988 — Yellowstone National Park is closed for the first time in U.S. history due to ongoing fires.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1994 — USAir Flight 427, on approach to Pittsburgh International Airport, suddenly crashes in clear weather killing all 132 aboard, resulting in the most extensive aviation investigation in world history and altering manufacturing practices in the industry.
- 2023 — The 2023 Rugby World Cup, the tenth men's Rugby World Cup is held in France. The opening ceremony, directed and written by Jean Dujardin, Olivier Ferracci and Nora Matthey, took place at the Stade de France in Saint-Denis, before the opening match between France and New Zealand...

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1973 — World Airways Flight 802 crashes into Mount Dutton in King Cove, Alaska, killing six people.

- 1986 — Nicholas Daniloff, a correspondent for U.S. News & World Report, is indicted on charges of espionage by the Soviet Union.
- 1962 — Last run of the famous Pines Express over the Somerset and Dorset Railway line (UK) fittingly using the last steam locomotive built by British Railways, BR Standard Class 9F 92220 Evening Star.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 252 of the year, 113 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Charles Lowder (Church of England); Christian feast day: Ciarán of Clonmacnoise; Christian feast day: Blessed Eurythimia Üffing; Christian feast day: Blessed Francisco Gárate Aranguren. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1967 — Chris Caffery, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1990 — Jordan Tabor, English footballer (died 2014)
- 1963 — Neil Fairbrother, English cricketer
- 1960 — Hugh Grant, English actor and producer
- 1982 — Graham Onions, English cricketer
- 1941 — Otis Redding, American singer-songwriter and producer (died 1967)
- 1991 — Hunter Hayes, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1964 — Aleksandar Hemon, Bosnian-American author and critic

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1988 — Vietnam Airlines Flight 831 crashes in Khu Khot, Thailand, while on approach to Don Muang International Airport, killing 76.
- 2014 — The album Songs of Innocence by U2 is digitally released at no charge to all customers of the iTunes Music Store, appearing automatically in the "purchased" section of over 500 million users worldwide.
- 2009 — The Dubai Metro, the first urban train network in the Arabian Peninsula, is ceremonially inaugurated.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2014 — The album Songs of Innocence by U2 is digitally released at no charge to all customers of the iTunes Music Store, appearing automatically in the "purchased" section of over 500 million users worldwide.
- 2001 — Ahmad Shah Massoud, leader of the Northern Alliance, is assassinated in Afghanistan by two al-Qaeda assassins who claimed to be Arab journalists wanting an interview.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar